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Professional Summary

AI and Data Management Expert with 13+ years of experience operating at the intersection of data governance, data management, and hands-on AI/GenAI delivery. Combines strategic guidance on enterprise-wide data management with direct contribution to AI and GenAI initiatives, from ideation to prototype to scalable production solutions. Proven track record ensuring data assets are high-quality, well-documented, traceable, and AI-ready through pragmatic data governance frameworks covering data quality, metadata, lineage, master/reference data, and responsible data usage. Hands-on expertise with Databricks, cloud-based analytics and AI services (Azure), and practical delivery of AI/ML and GenAI use cases including LLM pipelines and deep learning models with governance-by-design: explainability, auditability, quality gates, and compliance embedded from the start. Strong coaching and communication skills with experience training 500+ professionals and promoting data literacy and AI awareness across organizations. MSc in Machine Learning & AI (4.0 GPA). Fluent in English.

Core Competencies

Data Governance	Data Governance Frameworks, Policies & Standards, Operating Models, Data Quality, Metadata Management, Data Lineage, Master & Reference Data, Data Stewardship, Data Owner Accountability, Responsible Data Usage, Bias Awareness
Data Management	Enterprise Data Management, Data Architecture, Data Modeling, Data Cataloging, Data Documentation, Traceability, AI-readiness Assessment, Data Classification, Privacy & Compliance
AI / GenAI	LLM Pipelines, GenAI Prototyping, Deep Learning (LSTM, PyTorch, TensorFlow), NLP, Prompt Engineering, Agentic AI (familiar), AI Use Case Ideation, POC Development, Solution Design, Model Selection
Governance-by-Design	Explainability (SHAP, LIME), Auditability, Quality Gates, Data Lineage in AI, Compliance, Ethics, Model Validation, Bias Detection, Responsible AI, Risk Identification
Platforms	Databricks (Delta Lake, MLflow, Spark SQL), Azure (Azure ML, Azure AI, ADLS, ADF), SAP (familiar), Cloud Analytics & AI Services, MLOps, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD
Leadership	Coaching, Data Literacy Promotion, AI Awareness, Cross-functional Community Building, Stakeholder Engagement, Agile (Scrum, Kanban), International Collaboration

Professional Experience

Data Operations / Science Manager — Avenue Living Asset Management Jan 2022 – Present

- Act as subject-matter expert for enterprise-wide data management and AI enablement, combining strategic guidance on data governance with hands-on contribution to AI/GenAI initiatives across a multi-entity organization
- Design and evolve pragmatic data governance and data management frameworks (policies, standards, operating models) aligned with AI-driven use cases
- Ensure data assets are high-quality, well-documented, traceable, and AI-ready, covering data quality, metadata, lineage, master/reference data, bias awareness, and responsible data usage
- Work closely with business stakeholders, data owners, and stewards to clarify accountability, coach best practices, and embed governance into daily operations
- Contribute directly to AI/GenAI initiatives from ideation to prototype: translate business problems into data and AI requirements and build proofs of concept including LLM-powered classification (10,000+ daily records) and deep learning forecasting (LSTM, PyTorch)
- Apply governance-by-design in all AI solutions, ensuring explainability (SHAP, LIME), auditability, data lineage, quality gates, and compliance from the outset
- Contribute to technology and architecture decisions for data, analytics, and AI platforms on Databricks (Delta Lake, MLflow, Spark SQL) and Azure
- Support the transition from prototype to scalable solution in collaboration with engineering, MLOps, and platform teams using Docker, Kubernetes, and CI/CD pipelines
- Identify and escalate risks related to data security, privacy, ethics, and compliance, particularly in AI and GenAI contexts
- Promote data literacy and AI awareness across the organization, fostering a strong cross-functional data and AI community through training, coaching, and enablement programs
- Lead and manage a diverse team of data scientists, engineers, and analysts, providing coaching, career development, and performance feedback
- Lead Agile delivery practices (Scrum, Kanban) across data and AI teams, managing sprint planning and iterative delivery
- Led end-to-end analytics platform migration (Qlik to Power BI) with governance-by-design: data cataloging, documentation standards, quality gates, and metadata management for all BI workflows
- Designed scalable data pipelines on Databricks (Delta Lake, Spark) and Azure with automated data quality monitoring, lineage tracking, and governance frameworks

Senior Data Engineer — Calgary Homeless Foundation Feb 2020 – Dec 2021

- Designed enterprise data management and governance frameworks from the ground up for sensitive social services data, ensuring quality, privacy, compliance, and traceability
- Ensured data assets were well-documented, high-quality, and traceable with metadata management, lineage tracking, and data classification
- Identified and escalated risks related to data security, privacy, and compliance in a regulated environment
- Coached team members and stakeholders on data governance best practices and responsible data usage

Machine Learning Researcher — University of CalgaryJan 2020 – Dec 2021

- Contributed to AI/ML initiatives from ideation to prototype, designing experiments, building proofs of concept, and validating results with rigorous methodology
- Published peer-reviewed research on optimization methods, demonstrating analytical and conceptual thinking with practical implementation
- Applied explainability, validation, and reproducibility principles to all AI/ML experimentation

Senior Data Engineer — MCI Telecommunications2017 – 2019

- Acted as subject-matter expert for enterprise data management across customer, billing, and operational domains handling billions of records
- Designed and implemented data governance frameworks including data quality standards, metadata management, master/reference data, and lineage documentation at enterprise scale
- Worked closely with data owners and business stakeholders to clarify accountability and embed governance into daily operations across a large international organization
- Contributed to technology and architecture decisions for data and analytics platforms, ensuring scalability, reliability, and compliance
- Coached junior team members on data management best practices, promoting data literacy across engineering teams

Data Engineer — Export Development Bank of Iran (EDBI)June 2015 – Mar 2017

- Implemented data governance and data quality frameworks in a regulated banking environment with strict compliance, privacy, auditability, and traceability requirements
- Ensured data assets were well-documented and compliant with regulatory standards, managing master data and reference data for financial reporting
- Identified and escalated risks related to data security, privacy, and regulatory compliance

Technical Instructor — Kahkeshan Noor Institute, TehranSept 2012 – Mar 2018

- Promoted data literacy and technical awareness by training 500+ professionals in SQL, data management, data modeling, and analytics
- Demonstrated strong coaching and communication skills, conveying complex concepts with impact and influence to diverse audiences

Education

Master of Science, Computer Software EngineeringJan 2020 – Jan 2022University of Calgary • GPA: 4.0 • Specialization: Machine Learning & AI

Bachelor of Science, Information Technology Engineering2005 – 2009University of Sufi Razi, Zanjan, Iran • GPA: 3.8

Technical Skills

Data Governance	Data Quality, Metadata, Lineage, Master & Reference Data, Data Cataloging, Policies & Standards, Operating Models, Responsible AI	AI / GenAI	LLMs, GenAI, Deep Learning (PyTorch, TensorFlow), NLP, Prompt Engineering, Agentic AI (familiar), SHAP, LIME, Model Validation
Platforms	Databricks (Delta Lake, MLflow, Spark SQL), Azure (Azure ML, Azure AI, ADLS, ADF), SAP (familiar), Snowflake, PostgreSQL	MLOps	MLflow, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, Model Registry, Monitoring, Automated Retraining, Quality Gates
Languages	Python (advanced), SQL (12+ yrs), PySpark, Spark SQL, C#	Delivery	Agile (Scrum, Kanban), Sprint Planning, Jira, Confluence, Cross-functional Collaboration
Data Engineering	Data Pipelines, ETL/ELT, Data Architecture, Data Modeling, Apache Spark, Airflow, Data Onboarding, Storage Solutions	Communication	Coaching, Data Literacy Promotion, AI Awareness, Stakeholder Engagement, Training (500+), Mentoring (200+)

Professional Certifications

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)	Sep 2023
Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900)	Aug 2023
Microsoft Certified Solutions Developer (MCSD): Application Builder	2016
Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA): Web Applications	2014
Microsoft Certified Technology Specialist (MCTS): SQL Server 2008	2012

Key Data Governance & AI Deliveries

- Enterprise Data Governance Framework (Avenue Living):** Designed and implemented pragmatic data governance frameworks covering data quality, metadata, lineage, master data, and responsible data usage aligned with AI-driven use cases. Embedded governance-by-design into all AI/GenAI solutions
- GenAI with Governance-by-Design (Avenue Living):** Built LLM-powered classification pipeline with explainability, auditability, quality gates, bias awareness, and compliance embedded from ideation through production deployment
- Deep Learning with Responsible AI (Avenue Living):** Deployed LSTM pricing model with full governance: data lineage from source to prediction, model explainability (SHAP), validation quality gates, and documented auditability
- Regulated Data Governance (EDBI Banking):** Implemented data governance in regulated banking with strict compliance, privacy, master data management, and auditability requirements
- Enterprise Data Management at Scale (MCI Telecom):** Established data quality standards, metadata management, and master/reference data governance across billions of records in an international telecom organization
- Data Literacy & AI Awareness (500+ professionals):** Promoted data literacy and AI awareness across organizations through structured training, coaching, and cross-functional community building

Leadership & Community

- **Speaker Team Lead, DataCon 2026:** Leading speaker coordination for Data Society of Calgary’s flagship data and AI conference
- **AI & Data Mentor, Great Learning (2023–Present):** Coaching 200+ professionals on data management, AI, and career development
- **Keynote Speaker** "Designing Layered Software Architecture" Conference (2017, 2014)
- **Academic Excellence** University of Calgary, Perfect GPA 4.0 (2022)

Research & Publications

- "Optimization of inflationary inventory control model under stochastic conditions" Iranian Journal of Management Studies (2015)
- "Particle Swarm Optimization Approach for Ordering Policy in Inflationary Inventory System" IJAREAS (2014)

Languages

English (Professional Fluency) • Persian (Native) • Arabic (Conversational) • German (Basic/Learning)